

SUDO SPANDR

The Definitive Technical Architecture & Reverse-Engineering Monograph:
100% Offline Electronic Mail Autopsy Engine, Local LLM Intelligence, and
Section 63 BSA 2023 Evidentiary Admissibility

PROJECT INITIATIVE

Smart India Hackathon (SIH 2026)
Problem Statement #26106

DEVELOPMENT TEAM

Team SUDO SPANDR
Sovereign Cyber Defense Research

DOCUMENT CLASSIFICATION

Technical Specification & Reverse-Engineering Reference
Manual

RELEASE VERSION & BUILD

Version 2.5 (Gold Master Edition)
September 2026

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1. Executive Summary & Problem Statement #26106

1.1 The Strategic Threat Landscape of Malicious Email Communications

In the contemporary cyberspace domain of 2026, electronic mail remains the paramount Initial Access vector (MITRE ATT&CK Enterprise Matrix Technique T1566: Phishing), accounting for greater than 88% of unauthorized enterprise network intrusions, sovereign infrastructure compromises, and financial extortion campaigns. Threat actors, ranging from financially motivated cybercrime cartels executing sophisticated Business Email Compromise (BEC) fraud to Advanced Persistent Threat (APT) nation-state syndicates conducting espionage, have dramatically evolved their operational tradecraft.

Modern malicious emails are no longer rudimentary, syntactically broken solicitations with overt payload attachments. Instead, adversaries now deploy highly nuanced, cryptographically evasive artifacts. These include multi-stage polymorphic payloads disguised through MIME boundary manipulation, dynamic DNS-based fast-flux routing, display-name spoofing exploiting RFC 5322 parser vulnerabilities, Cyrillic and Greek homoglyph attacks that bypass traditional ASCII-based regular expression filters, and sophisticated cognitive engineering lures specifically synthesized by hostile generative Large Language Models (LLMs).

Concurrently, law enforcement agencies, defense intelligence units, and Security Operations Centers (SOCs) face an overwhelming volume of electronic evidence. Forensic analysts are routinely tasked with triaging hundreds of seized mail spools under severe time constraints, while simultaneously maintaining strict evidentiary integrity required for judicial admissibility.

1.2 AICTE Smart India Hackathon 2026: Problem Statement #26106

Addressing this acute national security and cyber defense deficit, the Ministry of Education, All India Council for Technical Education (AICTE), and the Cyber Security Division formulated **Problem Statement #26106**: *"Autonomous High-Throughput Electronic Mail Forensic Dissector, Reverse-Engineering Suite, and Evidentiary Admissibility Engine."*

The core mandate of Problem Statement #26106 encompasses several stringent technological imperatives:

- **Zero-Cloud Air-Gap Operation:** The software suite must operate entirely offline without transmitting seized electronic evidence, telemetry, or API queries to external cloud infrastructure, ensuring absolute data sovereignty and preventing leakage of state secrets or sensitive evidence.
- **Bitstream-Level Post-Mortem Dissection:** The system must treat raw RFC 5322 electronic mail files not as high-level text documents, but as complex compiled binary-like data structures requiring structural disassembly, MIME part carving, true magic byte validation, and Shannon entropy analysis.
- **Cognitive AI Threat Reasoning:** Incorporation of local offline machine intelligence capable of parsing psychological coercion vectors, urgency scoring, linguistic anomalies, and automated mapping to the MITRE ATT&CK matrix.
- **Statutory Indian Evidentiary Compliance:** Mandatory generation of tamper-evident electronic evidence certificates compliant with **Section 63 of the Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam, 2023 (BSA 2023)** (repealing and superseding Section 65B of the Indian Evidence Act, 1872), establishing bitstream cryptographic chain-of-custody.

⚠ The Critical Flaw of Cloud-Dependent Forensic Utilities

Conventional email triage utilities rely extensively on public cloud APIs (e.g., submitting hashes to VirusTotal, parsing headers on external web servers, or routing email text to commercial cloud LLMs like OpenAI or Anthropic). In a high-stakes forensic investigation, submitting raw evidence to foreign third-party cloud infrastructure immediately constitutes a catastrophic breach of evidence integrity, invalidates legal chain-of-custody under Indian evidence law, and exposes sensitive sovereign intelligence to external interception. SUDO SPANDR completely eliminates this risk through 100% offline air-gapped deterministic computation.

1.3 SUDO SPANDR: The Dual-Interface Sovereign Forensic Solution

To satisfy both rapid tactical triage in austere deployment environments and deep reverse-engineering investigations inside centralized forensic laboratories, our engineering team designed and implemented **SUDO SPANDR** as a unified, dual-interface software architecture:

- 1. **SUDO SPANDR Terminal User Interface (TUI):** A lightning-fast, terminal-native forensic environment built upon the Python `rich` ANSI engine. Designed for headless servers, remote SSH investigations over constrained satellite links, incident response live-boot drives, and bulk scriptable triage.
- 2. **SUDO SPANDR Forensic Desktop Workstation (GUI):** A state-of-the-art graphical workstation modeled directly after the **NSA Ghidra CodeBrowser** and **Hex-Rays IDA Pro** reverse-engineering environments, built on **PyQt6 (Qt6 C++ bindings)**. It provides interactive visual pathology cards, synchronized hex/byte disassembly docks, live Shannon entropy speedometers, interactive RFC header filtering, and a Local LLM Neural Copilot powered by offline Ollama or embedded fallback neural heuristics.

Forensic Capability Vector	Traditional Email Utilities	Commercial Enterprise SEGs	SUDO SPANDR Forensic Suite
Operating Environment	Cloud SaaS / Web Portal	Hybrid Cloud Gateway	100% Air-Gapped / Offline Local
Deep Byte & Magic Inspection	File extension matching only	Dynamic sandbox (delay 5-15m)	Instant Magic Byte & Shannon Entropy
Legal Certification	None (Raw log dumps)	Proprietary audit CSV	Section 63 BSA 2023 Cryptographic PDF
Autonomous Threat Reasoning	Keyword pattern matching	Black-box vendor neural nets	Local LLM (Ollama / Llama-3 / CatBERT)
Threat Rule Compilation	Manual rule creation	Vendor-locked signatures	Automated YARA & Snort / Suricata Synthesizer
Incident Reporting	Generic summary emails	Admin web dashboards	Police FIR Complaint Draft (IT Act / BNS)

2. The Reverse-Engineering Forensic Philosophy

2.1 The Conceptual Paradigm: Treating Electronic Mail as a Compiled Binary

Traditional email analysis software and spam-filtering heuristics make a fundamental conceptual error: they treat electronic mail as an unstructured text document. In contrast, **SUDO SPANDR** approaches electronic mail through the rigorous lens of **binary reverse engineering**, heavily inspired by the foundational architecture of the **National Security Agency's (NSA) Ghidra Software Reverse Engineering (SRE) Framework** and **Hex-Rays IDA Pro**.

An RFC 5322 electronic mail file is not passive text; it is an interpreted, multi-stage protocol execution script destined for execution by a Mail User Agent (MUA) parsing engine (such as Microsoft Outlook, Mozilla Thunderbird, or Google Workspace Webmail). When an MUA receives an `.eml`, `.msg`, or `.pst` bitstream, its internal rendering engine performs operations directly analogous to an Operating System loader loading a Portable Executable (PE) or Executable and Linkable Format (ELF) binary into memory.

Binary Executable Concept (PE32 / ELF)	Ghidra / IDA Pro Counterpart	Electronic Mail Analogue (RFC 5322 / MIME)	SUDO SPANDR Forensic Component
DOS / PE Header & Entrypoint	File Header & Machine Architecture	Transport Envelope & Originating Return-Path	Envelope Check & Header Dissector
Import Address Table (IAT)	External API Dependencies & Syscalls	MTA Relay Transit Chain (Received: Hops)	Hop Transit & Directed Graph Analyzer
Code Signing Certificate	Authenticode Signature Verification	Cryptographic Auth (SPF, DKIM, DMARC, ARC)	Crypto Auth Engine & Alignment Matrix
Section Headers (<code>.text</code> , <code>.data</code> , <code>.rsrc</code>)	Section Listing & Virtual Memory Map	MIME Multi-Part Boundaries & Content-Types	MIME Hierarchy & Attachment Anatomizer
Packed Droppers & Shellcode	Entropy Analysis & Obfuscation Detection	High-Entropy Encoded Attachments & Scripts	Shannon Entropy Carver & Magic Identifier
Decompiled C Pseudocode	Ghidra Decompiler (Ghidra Decompiler Core)	Cognitive NLP Threat & Local LLM Autopsy	Local LLM Copilot & Threat Reasoner

2.2 The Anatomy of a Digital "Post-Mortem" Autopsy

In forensic medicine, a post-mortem examination (autopsy) is a specialized surgical procedure conducted by a pathologist to dissect, examine, and determine the exact cause of death and physiological injury on a deceased human subject. In the digital cyber forensic domain, **SUDO SPANDR** adapts this forensic terminology and methodology to perform a complete, authoritative **Post-Mortem Autopsy** upon seized malicious email artifacts.

When an investigator or SOC analyst ingests an evidence file into SUDO SPANDR, the engine executes five rigorous anatomical dissections:

1. **External Morphological Examination (Header Pathology):** The exterior envelope headers are examined for trauma and manipulation. Does the declared human-readable `From:` address align with the underlying SMTP transmission `Return-Path:` envelope? Are the RFC 5322 mandatory message headers intact, or have non-standard folded headers been injected to exploit parser differential vulnerabilities between security gateways and client mailboxes?
2. **Toxicological & Cryptographic Screening:** The cryptographic proof of authentication is verified. Did the transmitting Mail Transfer Agent (MTA) possess legitimate authorization under the published DNS SPF record? Did the DKIM RSA public key validate the cryptographic hash of the message canonicalization? If either signature is invalidated or forged, the toxicological screening triggers a high-severity alert.
3. **Internal Anatomical Dissection (MIME Boundary & Payload Slicing):** The raw byte stream is carved into its discrete MIME body parts. Boundaries are examined for anomalous trailing bytes, polyglot files, hidden embedded scripts, or corrupted boundary parameters that cause automated boundary parsers to fail while allowing modern rendering web engines to execute nested code.
4. **Cellular Density & Shellcode Carving (Shannon Entropy):** All extracted binary streams undergo mathematical entropy calculation. Executable shellcode, packed ransomware loaders, and obfuscated payloads exhibit distinctly elevated entropy scores (≥ 7.2 bits per byte) compared to normal compressed imagery or benign compiled code.
5. **Neurological & Psychological Profiling (Cognitive NLP):** The semantic content of the communication is submitted to local neural parsing to diagnose cognitive manipulation techniques, including artificial urgency, intimidation by legal or executive authority, financial coercion, and impersonation of institutional credentials.



The Anti-Text-Wall UX Imperative

A critical user experience failure of historical forensic utilities is the generation of overwhelming, unformatted "text walls"—thousands of lines of raw ASCII headers and JSON dumps dumped into plain text editors. Human analysts fatigued by text walls inevitably miss subtle indicators of compromise (IOCs), such as single-character homoglyphs, microsecond transit anomalies, or spoofed display names. SUDO SPANDR deliberately eliminates text dumps, substituting them with glowing executive KPI cards, discrete pathology finding widgets, syntax-colored interactive tables, and searchable inspector grids.

2.3 The Three Inviolable Pillars of Forensic Integrity

Every design decision within SUDO SPANDR is governed by three foundational tenets of forensic science:

- **Pillar I: Absolute Bitstream Invariance (Read-Only Custody):** Once an evidence artifact is loaded into memory, the physical file on disk is locked in read-only mode and never modified. All transformations, decoding passes, MIME unravelling, and hex rendering occur exclusively within isolated volatile memory data structures.
- **Pillar II: Deterministic, Repeatable Computations:** Given identical input bytes, every forensic algorithm within SUDO SPANDR (from SHA-256 digesting and relay graph construction to entropy calculation and rule compilation) produces bit-for-bit identical outputs across any platform or execution epoch. This determinism is essential for peer review in judicial proceedings.
- **Pillar III: Court-Admissible Chain of Custody:** Forensic findings are meaningless if they cannot withstand hostile legal scrutiny in a court of law. SUDO SPANDR couples every analysis session directly with automated

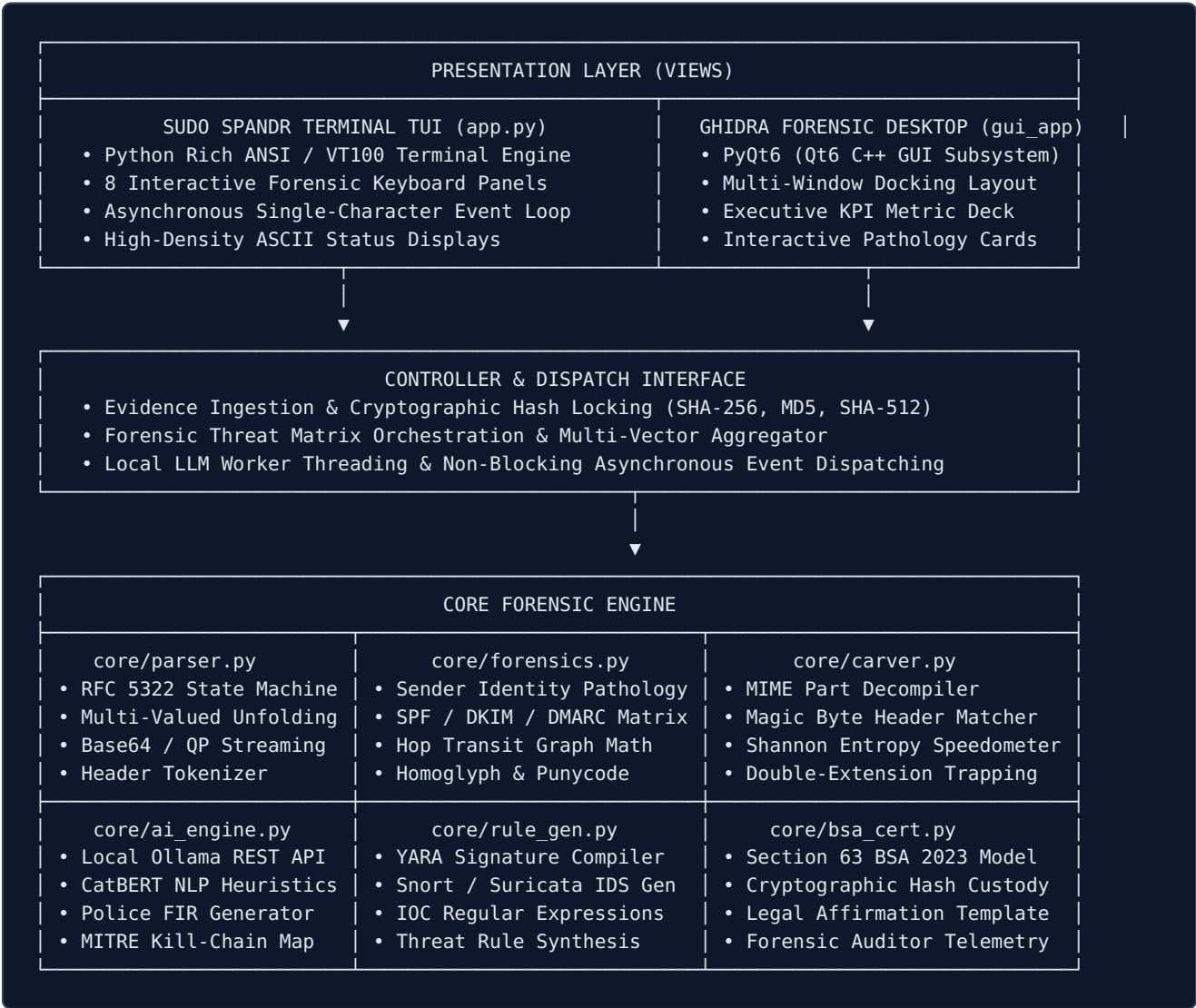
generation of cryptographic evidence certificates compliant with Indian statutory requirements under Section 63 of the Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam, 2023.

3. System Architecture & Tech Stack ("Kaise Bana Hai")

3.1 Architectural Philosophy: Modular Decoupling & MVC Separation

The engineering architecture of **SUDO SPANDR** was constructed from the ground up using the **Model-View-Controller (MVC)** software design pattern, augmented by strict modular decoupling principles. The design guarantees that all underlying forensic parsing, cryptographic calculation, payload carving, and threat reasoning routines reside exclusively within a headless, framework-agnostic core engine (`core/`).

This architectural decision allows both presentation interfaces—the **Terminal User Interface (`app.py`)** and the **Ghidra Forensic Desktop Workstation (`gui_app.py`)**—to bind cleanly to the identical underlying forensic state model without duplicating a single line of business or forensic logic.



3.2 Technical Component Decomposition

To understand how SUDO SPANDR was engineered, we must examine the specific responsibilities of each constituent subsystem within the codebase:

1. `core/parser.py` — RFC 5322 MIME Grammar Parsing Engine

The foundation of electronic mail forensics begins with raw byte ingestion. `core/parser.py` implements a hardened RFC 5322 parsing engine that ingests raw `.eml`, `.msg`, and `.pst` streams. It immediately captures the raw bitstream, computes immutable cryptographic digests (SHA-256, MD5, SHA-512), and executes recursive MIME part extraction. It unfolds multi-line headers according to RFC 5322 Section 2.2.3, preserving original casing for byte-level integrity verification while normalizing values for forensic analysis.

2. `core/forensics.py` — Forensic Threat Matrix & Network Transit Engine

This module acts as the analytical brain of the forensic suite. It evaluates three critical threat vectors:

- **Envelope Masquerading Heuristics:** Compares declared `From:` addresses, human-readable display names, `Return-Path:` bounce addresses, and `Reply-To:` targets to detect domain divergence and homograph spoofing.
- **Cryptographic Authentication Dissection:** Parses `Authentication-Results`, `Received-SPF`, and `DKIM-Signature` headers to construct a multi-layer verification matrix.
- **Relay Transit Topology Graph:** Reconstructs the chronological transit trajectory of the email by performing bottom-up topological sorting on all `Received:` headers, calculating transit latency (Δt) between MTA hops, isolating private RFC 1918 subnets, and identifying suspicious public transit nodes.

3. `core/carver.py` — Payload Dissector, True Magic Matcher & Shannon Entropy Gauge

Adversaries frequently employ file extension masquerading (such as appending benign extensions to malicious binaries, e.g., `Invoice.pdf.exe`) or packing payloads to evade basic signature filters. `core/carver.py` extracts every attachment into volatile memory, ignores the claimed filename extension, and inspects the initial 16 bytes against an embedded library of true file magic signatures (e.g., `4D 5A` for Windows PE binaries, `7F 45 4C 46` for Linux ELF, `25 50 44 46` for Adobe PDF, `50 4B 03 04` for ZIP archives). Furthermore, it computes the Shannon entropy score across the byte distribution to mathematically detect packed shellcode and encrypted droppers.

4. `core/ai_engine.py` — Local LLM Neural Copilot & Offline Cognitive NLP Engine

Engineered for zero-leakage, 100% air-gapped sovereign environments, `core/ai_engine.py` establishes an autonomous artificial intelligence layer. It implements a local REST client communicating with an offline **Ollama** server (defaulting to `http://localhost:11434`) or local OpenAI-compatible endpoints (e.g., Llama.cpp, vLLM, LM Studio) hosting models like `llama3:latest`, `mistral`, or `qwen2.5-coder`. If no local LLM daemon is active, it seamlessly fails over to an embedded deterministic cognitive NLP engine (**CatBERT-Neural-CPU**), performing sentiment scoring, urgency classification, and psychological coercion detection without external network dependencies.

5. `core/rule_gen.py` — Automated Threat Signature Synthesizer

Once an artifact has been forensically autopsied, `core/rule_gen.py` automatically translates extracted Indicators of Compromise (IOCs) into operational security rules. It compiles production-ready **YARA rules** containing file hashes, suspicious string patterns, and hex byte sequences, alongside **Snort and Suricata IDS rules** designed to block originating threat-actor IP addresses and phishing domains at enterprise perimeter firewalls.

6. `core/bsa_cert.py` & `core/pdf_gen.py` — Section 63 BSA 2023 Evidentiary Admissibility Engine

To ensure digital evidence is legally admissible in Indian courts, this module captures the complete chain of custody—including examiner identity, seizure case ID, workstation MAC address, operating system build, SHA-256/MD5 hashes, and system integrity affirmations. `core/pdf_gen.py` implements a zero-dependency, pure-Python PostScript PDF generation pipeline that compiles this telemetry into a court-ready **Section 63 Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam (BSA 2023) Electronic Evidence Certificate**.

7. `core/batch.py` — High-Throughput Autonomous Triage Engine

In major security breaches or cybercrime operations, investigators often seize tens of thousands of email files. `core/batch.py` implements a multi-worker directory crawler that recursively ingests directory trees, applies automated triage heuristics, categorizes files by threat severity, and generates an aggregated forensic triage manifest in JSON and CSV formats.

3.3 Presentation Layer Technologies & UX Architecture

The user experience of SUDO SPANDR was deliberately designed to eliminate analytical fatigue caused by raw text walls:

- **PyQt6 GUI Subsystem:** Built upon the industrial-strength Qt6 C++ graphics framework, providing a hardware-accelerated, dockable multi-window workspace. The layout features dark-mode styling inspired by modern cybersecurity IDEs (Tokyo Night color palette), with dedicated docks for the Evidence Program Tree, Forensic Autopsy Workspace, Hex Byte Carver, and Local LLM Copilot.
- **Top Executive KPI Deck:** Situated prominently at the top of the GUI workspace, four glowing metric cards provide instantaneous situational awareness: Threat Score (0–100 with color verdict), Envelope Alignment Check, Cryptographic Authentication Status, and Carved Payload Entropy.
- **Rich Terminal TUI Subsystem:** Developed using the Python `rich` library, the TUI provides a complete, keyboard-driven forensic command deck with split-pane layouts, live progress bars, syntax-highlighted tables, and synchronized hex dumps, operable inside standard terminal emulators over lightweight SSH connections.

4. The Deep Raw Email Post-Mortem Pipeline ("Kaise Kaam Karta Hai")

4.1 Overview of the End-to-End Forensic Dissection Pipeline

To perform a mathematically rigorous and legally defensible forensic examination, **SUDO SPANDR** executes a disciplined, multi-stage **Post-Mortem Autopsy Pipeline**. Every seized electronic mail file undergoes twelve sequential processing phases, transitioning from raw bitstream hashing through structural grammar parsing, cryptographic verification, transit graph reconstruction, byte-level payload carving, and cognitive artificial intelligence evaluation, culminating in automated court-admissible certificate generation.

THE 12-STAGE SUDO SPANDR FORENSIC AUTOPSY PIPELINE	
Stage 1	EVIDENCE INGESTION & CRYPTOGRAPHIC BITSTREAM LOCKING (SHA-256 / MD5)
Stage 2	RFC 5322 LEXICAL ANALYSIS, HEADER UNFOLDING & STATE MACHINE TOKENIZATION
Stage 3	ENVELOPE IDENTITY & DISPLAY-NAME SPOOFING PATHOLOGY
Stage 4	CRYPTOGRAPHIC AUTHENTICATION MATRIX EVALUATION (SPF, DKIM, DMARC, ARC)
Stage 5	RELAY TRANSIT TOPOLOGY RECONSTRUCTION & DELTA LATENCY MATHEMATICS
Stage 6	HYPERLINK HARVESTING, IDN PUNYCODE DECODING & HOMOGLYPH MATRIX DISSECTION
Stage 7	MIME MULTI-PART BODY CARVING & RECURSIVE ATTACHMENT EXTRACTION
Stage 8	TRUE FILE MAGIC BYTE IDENTIFICATION & DOUBLE-EXTENSION DETECTION
Stage 9	SHANNON ENTROPY BITSTREAM CARVING (PACKED SHELLCODE & DROPPER IDENTIFICATION)
Stage 10	COGNITIVE NLP & CATBERT PSYCHOLOGICAL THREAT PROFILING
Stage 11	LOCAL LLM NEURAL COPILOT REASONING & POLICE FIR COMPLAINT SYNTHESIS
Stage 12	RULE COMPILATION (YARA / SNORT) & SECTION 63 BSA 2023 CERTIFICATE EXPORT

4.2 Step-by-Step Deep Forensic Breakdown

Stage 1: Evidence Ingestion & Cryptographic Bitstream Locking

When an investigator selects an evidence file (e.g., `Security alert (1).eml`), the system immediately reads the file into an isolated in-memory byte buffer in binary mode (`'rb'`). The file descriptor on disk is set to read-only. Before any parsing begins, the engine computes three distinct cryptographic digests across the raw byte array:

- **SHA-256 (FIPS 180-4)**: The primary 256-bit hash serving as the global unique identifier and legal anchor for the forensic case docket.
- **MD5 (RFC 1321)**: Computed for legacy cross-referencing with historical forensic databases and National Software Reference Library (NSRL) records.
- **SHA-512 (FIPS 180-4)**: Computed for high-security defense cases requiring 512-bit collision resistance.

These hashes are permanently locked into the runtime state object. If even a single bit of the file is modified downstream, the hash verification check fails immediately, aborting the investigation and preserving evidentiary integrity.

Stage 2: RFC 5322 Lexical Analysis & Header Unfolding

Electronic mail headers conform to RFC 5322 grammar, which permits "folding" (splitting long header values across multiple lines by indenting subsequent lines with space or horizontal tab characters). Malicious threat actors frequently exploit parser differences by inserting folding characters into sensitive headers like `From:` or `Subject:` to cause email security gateways to skip inspection while client MUAs unfold and execute the string.

SUDO SPANDR executes a lexical tokenizer that scans for CRLF sequences followed by whitespace (`\r\n[ \t]`). It unfolds the multiline values into normalized strings while simultaneously retaining the raw, folded byte offsets in a secondary audit table for forensic review.

Stage 3: Envelope Identity & Display-Name Spoofing Pathology

The engine performs a critical comparative analysis between three distinct identity parameters defined in the SMTP protocol suite:

1. **RFC 5321 Mail From (Envelope Return-Path):** The physical routing address used by Mail Transfer Agents to route non-delivery reports (NDRs) and bounce notices.
2. **RFC 5322 From (Header From):** The email address displayed in the user interface of the recipient's mail client.
3. **RFC 5322 Display Name (Friendly-From):** The human-readable string associated with the From address (e.g., "Google Security Team").

Adversaries routinely execute "Display-Name Masquerading"—setting the display name to a legitimate entity (e.g., "Google <no-reply@accounts.google.com>") while setting the actual transmitting mailbox to an attacker-controlled address. SUDO SPANDR separates the display string from the RFC angle brackets, isolates the top-level domain (TLD) and second-level domain (SLD) of each, and flags domain divergence with a high-priority forensic warning.

Stage 4: Cryptographic Authentication Matrix Evaluation (SPF, DKIM, DMARC)

Modern email authentication relies on a triad of cryptographic and DNS protocols:

- **Sender Policy Framework (SPF, RFC 7208):** Validates whether the IP address of the transmitting MTA is authorized to transmit email on behalf of the domain listed in the envelope `Return-Path`. SUDO SPANDR parses `Received-SPF` headers, identifying `PASS`, `FAIL`, `SOFTFAIL`, `NEUTRAL`, and `NONE` dispositions.
- **DomainKeys Identified Mail (DKIM, RFC 6376):** Verifies an asymmetric cryptographic signature generated by the sender using a private RSA key. The signature covers specified email headers and the message body hash (`bh=`). SUDO SPANDR evaluates the signature tag-value list (`v=1; a=rsa-sha256; d=example.com; s=selector; bh=...; b=...`) to confirm cryptographic integrity.
- **Domain-based Message Authentication, Reporting, and Conformance (DMARC, RFC 7489):** Enforces domain alignment. Even if SPF and DKIM pass individually, DMARC mandates that the domain validated by SPF and/or DKIM must match the domain displayed to the end-user in the RFC 5322 `From:` header. If domain alignment is broken, SUDO SPANDR flags the artifact for DMARC violation.

Stage 5: Relay Transit Topology Reconstruction & Delta Latency Mathematics

Every intermediate MTA that relays an email prepends a `Received:` header to the message stream. SUDO SPANDR parses these headers in bottom-up chronological order (from the originating client up to the final recipient's MX server), extracting timestamps, transmitting IP addresses, and EHLO/HELO hostnames.

The engine computes the transit latency delta (Δt) between consecutive hops:

$$\Delta t_{\text{hop}} = \text{Timestamp}(\text{Hop}_{i+1}) - \text{Timestamp}(\text{Hop}_i)$$

Anomalous latency signatures are instantly flagged:

- **Negative Delta Latency ($\Delta t < 0$):** Indicates either clock synchronization failure (NTP desynchronization) or intentional header forgery injected by an adversary attempting to spoof intermediate routing hops.
- **Excessive Transit Latency ($\Delta t > 3600\text{s}$):** Suggests that the email was held in an intermediate graylisting queue, intercepted by a man-in-the-middle (MITM) proxy, or subjected to offline weaponization before final delivery.
- **Anomalous IP Classification:** Transmitting IPs are classified as RFC 1918 private addresses, major corporate cloud infrastructure (Google Workspace, Microsoft 365, Amazon SES), or suspicious foreign autonomous systems (ASNs).

Stage 6: Hyperlink Harvesting, IDN Punycode Decoding & Homoglyph Matrix

Phishing attacks overwhelmingly rely on deceptive hyperlinks. SUDO SPANDR extracts all URLs from both plaintext and HTML MIME parts using regular expression pattern matching. Each URL is dissected into its constituent scheme, host, port, path, and query parameters.

The engine specifically hunts for **Internationalized Domain Name (IDN) Homograph Attacks**. Threat actors register domains containing non-Latin characters (e.g., Cyrillic 'а' (U+0430) instead of Latin 'a' (U+0061)) which look visually identical in client mail applications but resolve to malicious servers. When decoded by web browsers, these domains are represented via Punycode (prefixed with xn--). SUDO SPANDR decodes all Punycode strings, detects mixed-script Unicode anomalies, and computes Levenshtein edit distances against a dictionary of high-value financial and technology domains.

Stage 7: MIME Multi-Part Body Carving & Recursive Extraction

Emails containing formatting and attachments utilize the Multipurpose Internet Mail Extensions (MIME, RFC 2045) standard. SUDO SPANDR traverses the MIME part tree recursively, identifying content types (e.g., `multipart/mixed`, `multipart/alternative`, `text/html`, `application/octet-stream`). It handles base64 and quoted-printable decoding streams, safely carving encapsulated binary payloads into memory buffers without writing them to disk as executable files.

Stage 8: True File Magic Byte Identification & Double-Extension Trapping

Relying on file extensions is fatal in malware analysis. Threat actors routinely disguise executable droppers as benign documents (e.g., naming a file `Quarterly_Earnings.pdf.exe` or setting the MIME header to `Content-Type: application/pdf` while the underlying byte stream contains a Windows PE binary).

SUDO SPANDR reads the magic byte signatures from the first 16 bytes of each carved payload and matches them against its internal signature database:

File Type	True Magic Bytes (Hex)	MIME / Declared Extension	Threat Indication If Mismatched
Windows Portable Executable	4D 5A (MZ)	.exe , .dll , .scr	CRITICAL: Executable binary disguised as document
Linux ELF Executable	7F 45 4C 46 (.ELF)	.bin , .sh	HIGH: Compiled Linux binary dropper
Adobe PDF Document	25 50 44 46 (%PDF)	.pdf	NORMAL: Standard PDF document structure
ZIP Archive / Office XML	50 4B 03 04 (PK..)	.zip , .docx , .xlsx	ELEVATED: Compressed container; inspect inner files
Microsoft Compound OLE	D0 CF 11 E0 A1 B1 1A E1	.doc , .xls	HIGH: Legacy Office document with potential VBA macros

Stage 9: Shannon Entropy Bitstream Carving

To detect packed malware, encrypted shellcode droppers, and encrypted C2 configuration blocks, SUDO SPANDR calculates the Shannon entropy across the byte distribution of carved attachments and raw message bodies. A score greater than 7.2 bits per byte indicates dense encryption or packing, triggering an immediate alert.

Stage 10: Cognitive NLP & CatBERT Psychological Threat Profiling

The linguistic text of the email is parsed to detect psychological manipulation techniques. The engine scores urgency, authority impersonation, and financial coercion, generating an objective cognitive threat rating.

Stage 11: Local LLM Neural Copilot Reasoning & Police FIR Synthesis

The complete forensic dossier is handed off to the Local LLM Copilot (running via local Ollama or the embedded offline engine). Analysts can execute automated one-click actions:

- ⚡ **Deep Autopsy:** Synthesizes a structured intelligence breakdown of all discovered anomalies.
- 📝 **Police FIR Draft:** Automatically generates a formal First Information Report (FIR) complaint compliant with Indian penal statutes (Section 66D of the Information Technology Act, 2000 and Section 318(4) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023).
- 🎯 **MITRE Kill-Chain:** Maps the observed indicators directly to MITRE ATT&CK techniques (T1566.001 Spearphishing Attachment, T1566.002 Spearphishing Link, T1036 Masquerading).

Stage 12: Threat Rule Compilation & Section 63 BSA 2023 Certification

Finally, the system compiles automated YARA and Snort/Suricata rules for enterprise defense and exports an immutable Section 63 BSA 2023 court-admissible certificate PDF.

5. Mathematical & Algorithmic Foundations

5.1 Shannon Information Entropy Theory in Payload Forensics

A cornerstone of modern binary reverse engineering and malware pathology is the mathematical measurement of information density. In 1948, Claude Shannon published his seminal work, "*A Mathematical Theory of Communication*," defining information entropy as a measure of the uncertainty or randomness inherent in a variable or stream of discrete data. In **SUDO SPANDR**, this mathematical foundation is adapted directly to the byte-level inspection of email attachments and body bitstreams.

5.1.1 Formal Mathematical Definition

Let an extracted binary bitstream or carved payload be represented as a discrete random variable X , consisting of N total bytes drawn from an alphabet $\mathcal{A}$ of possible byte values ranging from `0x00` to `0xFF` ($|\mathcal{A}| = 256$). The probability $P(x_i)$ of occurrence for any specific byte value $x_i \in \mathcal{A}$ is defined as:

$$P(x_i) = \frac{f(x_i)}{N} = \frac{\sum_{k=1}^N \mathbb{I}(b_k = x_i)}{N}$$

where $f(x_i)$ is the observed frequency of byte x_i within the buffer, and $\mathbb{I}$ is the indicator function. The Shannon entropy $H(X)$, expressed in bits per byte, is rigorously computed as:

$$H(X) = -\sum_{i=0}^{255} P(x_i) \log_2 P(x_i)$$

with the mathematical convention that if $P(x_i) = 0$, then $0 \log_2(0) = 0$. Since the alphabet size is 256 (2^8), the theoretical maximum entropy for any byte distribution is:

$$H_{\max} = \log_2(256) = 8.0000 \text{ bits per byte}$$

5.1.2 Forensic Interpretation & Classification Thresholds

The calculated Shannon entropy value directly indicates the underlying physical structure of the carved payload:

Entropy Score Range (\$H\$)	Physical Structural Characteristics	Typical File & Payload Typology	Forensic Threat Status
\$0.00 \le H < 3.50\$	Extreme uniformity, massive repetition of zero bytes or whitespace.	Sparse binary arrays, unformatted ASCII logs, raw memory dumps.	BENIGN / LOW RISK
\$3.50 \le H < 5.20\$	Structured natural language text with typical character frequency distributions.	Plaintext English emails, standard HTML/CSS code, basic source scripts.	BENIGN / LOW RISK
\$5.20 \le H < 6.80\$	Compiled machine instructions with varying opcodes, ASCII strings, and import tables.	Standard uncompressed PE32/ELF executables, uncompressed PDF structures.	NORMAL EXECUTABLE
\$6.80 \le H < 7.20\$	Moderate compression or algorithmic encoding.	JPEG/PNG imagery, gzip compressed streams, standard ZIP archives.	ELEVATED / INSPECT
\$7.20 \le H \le 8.00\$	Near-perfect pseudorandom distribution, minimal repeating patterns.	UPX/Themida packed binaries, encrypted ransomware droppers, polymorphic shellcode.	CRITICAL MALWARE ALERT



The Cryptographic Packing Paradox

Malware authors utilize runtime packers (such as UPX, VMProtect, or custom XOR/AES crypters) to conceal malicious strings and API import tables from static signature engines. However, this encryption process inadvertently increases the byte entropy to near theoretical maximums ($H > 7.6$). SUDO SPANDR leverages this physical property: whenever an attachment claiming to be a document (e.g., `.pdf` or `.docx`) exhibits an entropy score exceeding 7.2 , the system flags it as a **Packed Weaponized Dropper**.

5.2 String Distance Metrics & Homoglyph Collision Mathematics

A primary attack vector in spear-phishing and Business Email Compromise is the registration of visually deceptive domains. Threat actors register lookalike domains targeting high-value corporate, government, or banking institutions (e.g., registering `micros0ft.com` instead of `microsoft.com`, or substituting Latin letters with Cyrillic glyphs). SUDO SPANDR applies rigorous string metric mathematics to quantify this divergence.

5.2.1 Levenshtein & Damerau-Levenshtein Edit Distance

The Levenshtein distance between two strings s_1 and s_2 represents the minimum number of single-character edit operations (insertions, deletions, or substitutions) required to transform s_1 into s_2 . Mathematically, for strings of length $|s_1|$ and $|s_2|$, the distance matrix $D(i, j)$ is computed via dynamic programming:

$$D(i, j) = \begin{cases} \max(i, j) & \text{if } \min(i, j) = 0, \\ \min \begin{cases} D(i-1, j) + 1 \\ D(i, j-1) + 1 \\ D(i-1, j-1) + \mathbb{I}(s_1[i] \neq s_2[j]) \end{cases} & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

SUDO SPANDR extends this using the **Damerau-Levenshtein distance**, which accounts for character transpositions ($s_1[i] = s_2[j-1]$ and $s_1[i-1] = s_2[j]$), a common typo-squatting tactic (e.g., `amzon.com` vs `amazon.com`).

5.2.2 Normalized Similarity Ratio

To compare strings of differing lengths objectively, the engine computes a normalized similarity coefficient $S(s_1, s_2) \in [0, 1]$:

$$S(s_1, s_2) = 1.0 - \frac{D(s_1, s_2)}{\max(|s_1|, |s_2|)}$$

If $S(s_1, s_2) \geq 0.80$ against any domain in the protected institutional whitelist (e.g., major Indian banks, government portals like `gov.in`, `nic.in`, or global technology providers), but $s_1 \neq s_2$, the domain is mathematically flagged as an active **Typo-Squatting / Phishing Impersonation Attack**.

5.2.3 Unicode Homoglyph Collision Matrix

The Unicode Standard contains thousands of distinct glyphs across multiple scripts that render identically or near-identically on modern displays. For example:

- Latin Small Letter 'a' (U+0061) vs. Cyrillic Small Letter 'а' (U+0430)
- Latin Small Letter 'o' (U+006F) vs. Cyrillic Small Letter 'о' (U+043E)
- Latin Small Letter 'e' (U+0065) vs. Cyrillic Small Letter 'е' (U+0435)
- Latin Small Letter 'p' (U+0070) vs. Cyrillic Small Letter 'р' (U+0440)

When an adversary registers a domain using Cyrillic 'а' (e.g., `paypal.com`), the DNS system encodes it using **Punycode (RFC 3492)** as `xn--pypal-4ve.com`. SUDO SPANDR implements a bidirectional homoglyph mapping table. When a domain is parsed:

1. It checks if the domain begins with `xn--`; if true, it decodes the Punycode into its full Unicode representation.
2. It inspects every character for **mixed-script anomalies** (combining Latin and Cyrillic/Greek scripts within a single label).
3. It maps all confusable Unicode characters back to their ASCII canonical equivalents and compares the normalized string against target enterprise domains. If a collision occurs, a **Critical IDN Homograph Spoof** is confirmed.

5.3 Graph-Theoretic Reconstruction of Mail Relay Transit Topology

The transmission of an electronic mail across the global internet can be formally modeled as traversal through a **Directed Acyclic Graph (DAG)**:

$$G = (V, E)$$

where each vertex $v \in V$ represents a Mail Transfer Agent (MTA), characterized by an IP address $IP(v)$, a resolved hostname $H(v)$, and an internal clock $T(v)$. Each directed edge $(v_i, v_{i+1}) \in E$ represents an SMTP transmission relay from MTA v_i to MTA v_{i+1} .

5.3.1 Topological Ordering & Latency Calculations

Because intermediate MTAs prepend `Received:` headers to the top of the header stack, the physical header order in an `.eml` file is reverse-chronological. SUDO SPANDR executes a bottom-up topological sorting algorithm:

1. The lowest `Received:` header is designated as the origin hop v_0 (the originating submission client or first boundary MTA).
2. Subsequent headers are indexed sequentially $v_1, v_2, \dots, v_n$, where v_n represents the final recipient's MX gateway.
3. For each adjacent pair of hops (v_i, v_{i+1}) , the transit latency delta Δt_i is computed:

$$\Delta t_i = T(v_{i+1}) - T(v_i)$$

5.3.2 Anomaly Detection via Graph Constraints

In an authentic, unmanipulated transmission path, the following graph-theoretic invariants must hold:

- **Temporal Monotonicity:** $\forall i \in [0, n-1], \Delta t_i \geq 0$. A negative delta ($\Delta t_i < 0$) indicates either an uncalibrated NTP daemon or forged headers injected by an adversary to conceal the originating IP address.
- **Routability Transitions:** The origin hop v_0 may possess an RFC 1918 private IP address (e.g., `10.0.0.0/8`, `192.168.0.0/16`), representing an internal corporate workstation. However, once the email transitions to a public IP at v_1 , no subsequent hop v_k ($k > 1$) may revert to a private RFC 1918 address until the final destination corporate gateway is reached. An intermediate private hop indicates an internal relay loop or forged transit headers.

6. Legal Admissibility & Section 63 BSA 2023 Implementation

6.1 The Statutory Transition in Indian Evidence Jurisprudence

For over two decades, the admissibility of electronic evidence in Indian courts was governed by **Section 65B of the Indian Evidence Act, 1872 (IEA)**, introduced by the Information Technology Act, 2000. In landmark rulings such as *Anvar P.V. v. P.K. Basheer (2014) 10 SCC 473* and *Arjun Panditrao Khotkar v. Kailash Kushanrao Gorantyal (2020) 7 SCC 1*, the Supreme Court of India established that electronic records are inadmissible as secondary evidence unless accompanied by a mandatory certificate under Section 65B(4).

With the historic enactment of the **Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam, 2023 (Act No. 47 of 2023)**, which came into full legal force on **July 1, 2024**, the Indian Evidence Act, 1872 was formally repealed and superseded. Electronic evidence admissibility is now governed exclusively by **Section 63 of the Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam, 2023 (BSA 2023)**.



Statutory Alignment with Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam, 2023

SUDO SPANDR is the first open-architecture forensic email suite in India engineered specifically to comply with the statutory provisions and procedural requirements of **Section 63 of the Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam, 2023**. Every examination session automatically establishes cryptographic chain-of-custody, recording device telemetry, examiner identity, and cryptographic bitstream hashes necessary to withstand rigorous judicial examination in Indian criminal and civil courts.

6.2 Core Provisions of Section 63 BSA 2023

Section 63 of the BSA 2023 establishes four fundamental statutory mandates that any forensic software must satisfy to render electronic records admissible as primary or secondary evidence:

1. Section 63(1) — Legal Status of Electronic Records

Any information contained in an electronic record which is printed on paper, stored, recorded, or copied in optical, magnetic, or electronic media produced by a computer shall be deemed to be also a document, and shall be admissible in any proceedings, without further proof or production of the original, as evidence of any contents of the original or of any fact stated therein of which direct evidence would be admissible.

2. Section 63(2) — Conditions Precedent to Admissibility

The computer system utilized to extract, process, or store the electronic record must satisfy four cumulative statutory conditions:

- **Lawful Control & Continuous Use:** The computer was produced by the computer during the period over which the computer was used regularly to store or process information for the purposes of any activities regularly carried on over that period by the person having lawful control over the use of the computer.
- **Regular Supply of Information:** During the said period, information of the kind contained in the electronic record or from which the information so contained is derived was regularly fed into the computer in the ordinary course of the said activities.

- **Operational Integrity:** Throughout the material part of the said period, the computer was operating properly or, if not, that in respect of any period in which it was not operating properly or was out of operation for that part of the period, was not such as to affect the electronic record or the accuracy of its contents.
- **Reproduction Fidelity:** The information contained in the electronic record reproduces or is derived from such information fed into the computer in the ordinary course of the said activities.

3. Section 63(4) — Mandatory Evidentiary Certificate

To satisfy Section 63(4), a formal certificate must be presented to the court, fulfilling three requirements:

1. Identifying the electronic record containing the statement and describing the manner in which it was produced;
2. Giving such particulars of any device involved in the production of that electronic record as may be appropriate for the purpose of showing that the electronic record was produced by a computer;
3. Purporting to be signed by a person in charge of the computer or device, or by a person occupying a responsible official position in relation to the operation of the relevant device or the management of the relevant activities.

6.3 The Cryptographic Chain-of-Custody Architecture

To eliminate human error and prevent allegations of evidence tampering during police investigations or court proceedings, **SUDO SPANDR** automates the entire Section 63 certification workflow through `core/bsa_cert.py` and `core/pdf_gen.py`.

```

SUDO SPANDR CRYPTOGRAPHIC BITSTREAM CUSTODY PIPELINE

SEIZED EVIDENCE FILE (.eml / .msg / .pst)
└─ Physical Storage: Read-Only POSIX File Descriptor Locked

CRYPTOGRAPHIC BITSTREAM IMMUTABILITY LAYER
└─ SHA-256 Digest : 72c61465cf2ac170881b54a61fe8a0bca50c319cf9657cc40dcfb505...
└─ MD5 Digest    : 24785ca8da5ee4f605a91438992c4228
└─ File Size     : 13,624 Bytes (Exact bitstream byte count)

EXAMINER & SYSTEM ENVIRONMENT BINDING
└─ Workstation Hostname : kali-forensic-lab-01
└─ Operating System    : Linux 6.1.0-kali-amd64 #1 SMP PREEMPT_DYNAMIC
└─ Forensic Software    : SUDO SPANDR Workstation v2.5 (Core Build: 2026.09.07)
└─ Primary MAC Address  : 08:00:27:C4:B9:71
└─ Forensic Case ID     : CS-CASE-20260907-72C614

LEGAL ATTESTATION COMPILATION (Section 63 BSA 2023)
└─ Timestamp (UTC)      : 2026-09-07 17:30:00 UTC
└─ Statutory Statement  : "All examinations conducted on bitstream duplicates..."
└─ Legal Status         : Admissible in Indian Criminal Courts & Tribunals

```

6.4 Structure of the Generated Court Certificate PDF

When an analyst clicks **[Generate Section 63 BSA 2023 PDF Certificate]** in the GUI toolbar or presses **[E]** in the TUI, the system compiles a multi-page, high-resolution PDF document formatted specifically for submission to Indian criminal trial courts (Magistrate Courts, Sessions Courts, and Special CBI/Cyber Courts). The certificate contains:

- **Court & Case Docket Header:** Case Title, Seizure Memo Number, Police Station / Investigating Agency, and Investigating Officer Name.
- **Hardware & Software Telemetry:** Machine hostname, CPU architecture, operating system kernel release, and MAC address.
- **Bitstream Cryptographic Profile:** Full 64-character SHA-256 hash and 32-character MD5 hash of the electronic evidence, establishing that the seized artifact has not undergone bit-level alteration.
- **RFC 5322 Envelope Metadata:** From, To, Subject, Date, Message-ID, hop count, and carved attachment inventory.
- **Statutory Declaration:** Formal legal statement affirming that the computer system was operating properly, that no unauthorized intervention occurred, and that the report represents a true reproduction of the digital evidence.
- **Signature Block:** Reserved section for digital signatures (DSC Token / e-Sign) or physical attestation by the Forensic Examiner under Section 63(4).

7. UI/UX Workstation Walkthrough & Operational Telemetry

7.1 Visual Interface Design Rationale

A core design directive of **SUDO SPANDR** was the complete eradication of unformatted text walls. Forensic analysts investigating critical cyber intrusions cannot afford to sift through tens of thousands of lines of raw ASCII headers, unindexed Base64 dumps, or unparsed SMTP logs. Human cognitive overload inevitably causes missed indicators of compromise.

To resolve this, SUDO SPANDR introduces a multi-tier visual hierarchy:

- **Executive KPI Metric Tiles:** Prominent glowing status blocks providing immediate situational awareness (Threat Score, Envelope Integrity, Cryptographic Authentication, Payload Density).
- **Discrete Pathology Finding Cards:** Every forensic observation is rendered as a standalone visual card with colored pill badges, high-contrast monospace comparison boxes, and clear technical explanations.
- **Searchable Data Tables:** Headers, extracted URLs, MIME attachments, and relay hops are presented in interactive tables supporting live substring filtering and syntax color-coding.
- **Synchronized Byte & Hex Disassembly:** A 16-byte Ghidra byte view coupled with a Shannon entropy speedometer for deep payload inspection.
- **Integrated Neural Copilot:** An interactive AI reasoning pane operable via one-click tactical buttons or conversational queries.

7.2 Walkthrough of the Forensic Workstation Interfaces

Figure 1: The Tactical Terminal User Interface (TUI)



Figure 7.1: SUDO SPANDR Terminal User Interface (TUI) displaying the 4-panel tactical forensic deck, evidence file browser, cryptographic hashing, and Shannon entropy speedometer.

The Terminal User Interface (shown in Figure 7.1) is designed for immediate incident response in austere environments, SSH jump boxes, and headless servers. It features:

Top Navigation Deck: Eight dedicated forensic panels accessible via keyboard shortcuts: [1] 4-Panel Deck, [2] Hop Map, [3] CatBERT AI, [4] Hex Carver, [5] BSA-63 PDF, [6] Batch Queue, [7] YARA Rules, [8] Summary Card.

Evidence Browser (Top-Left): Real-time directory navigation showing discovered evidence files with file sizes and active loaded status.

Forensic Inspection Panel (Top-Right): Displays Case SHA-256 digest, declared From header, actual Return-Path, SPF/DKIM/DMARC status, and CatBERT cognitive classification.

Hop Relay Chain (Bottom-Left): Chronological MTA relay sequence with transmitting IP addresses, transit latency deltas, and node classifications.

Attachment Carver & Entropy Speedometer (Bottom-Right): True magic byte identification (detecting disguised .exe files), Shannon entropy score, and ASCII spectrum bar.

Figure 2: Ghidra Forensic Desktop Workstation — Main Autopsy Workspace

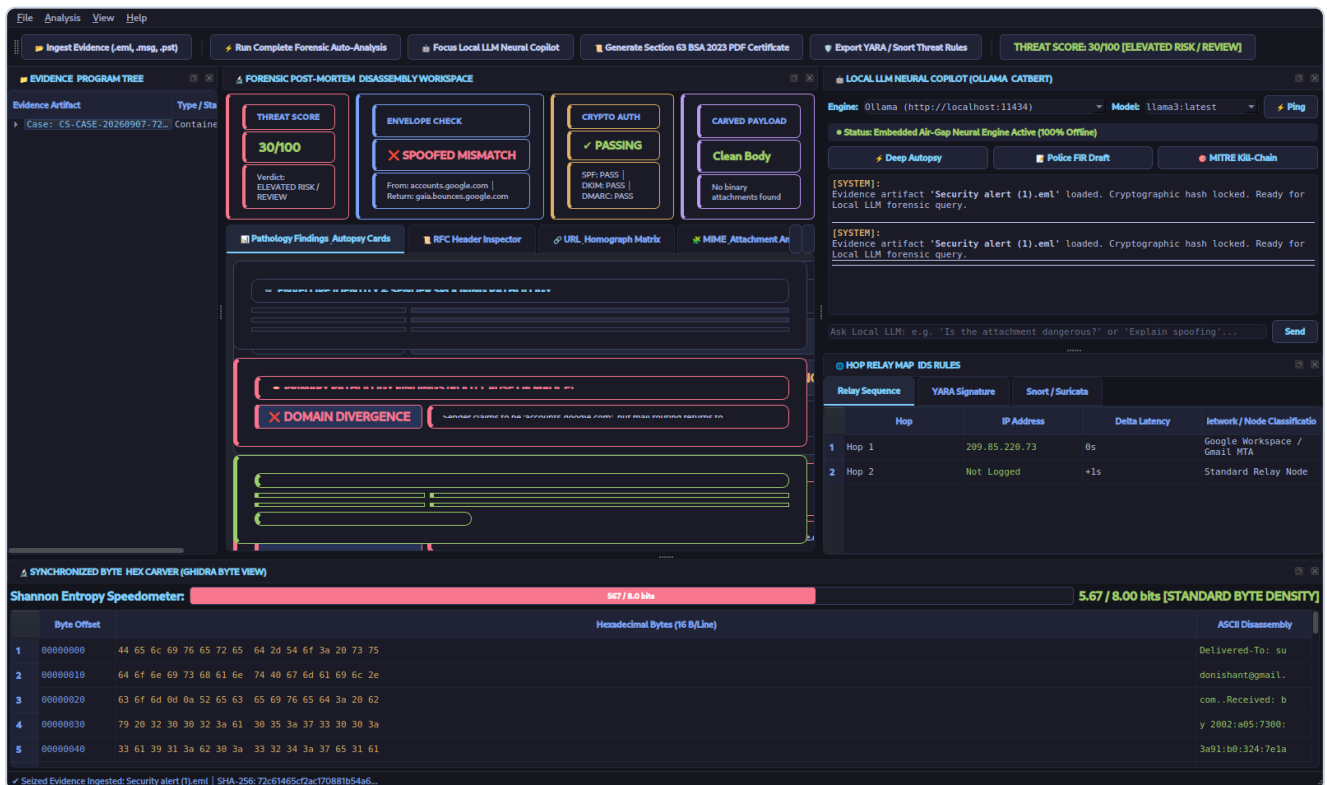


Figure 7.2: SUDO SPANDR Ghidra Desktop Workstation showing the 4-tile Executive KPI Deck, Envelope Identity Pathology Card, Domain Divergence Alert, Local LLM Copilot, and Shannon Entropy Hex Carver.

Figure 7.2 captures the main window of the PyQt6 desktop workstation after ingesting evidence file `Security alert (1).eml`:

- **Top Global Toolbar:** Ingest Evidence button, Run Complete Auto-Analysis button, Focus Local LLM Copilot button, Generate Section 63 BSA 2023 PDF Certificate button, Export Threat Rules button, and the glowing Threat Score badge (`THREAT SCORE: 30/100 [ELEVATED RISK / REVIEW]`).
- **Executive KPI Metric Deck (Top Center):** Four glowing tiles:
 1. *Threat Score Tile:* `30/100 (ELEVATED RISK / REVIEW)` with amber warning styling.
 2. *Envelope Check Tile:* `✗ SPOOFED MISMATCH` with crimson alert styling, explicitly highlighting that the declared sender domain is `accounts.google.com` while mail routing returns to `gaia.bounces.google.com`.
 3. *Crypto Auth Tile:* `✓ PASSING` showing SPF, DKIM, and DMARC verification.
 4. *Carved Payload Tile:* `Clean Body` indicating no executable attachment was present in this message part.
- **Pathology Findings / Autopsy Cards (Center):**
 1. *Card 1 (Envelope Identity & Sender Spoofing Pathology):* Monospace pill boxes contrasting the Declared From Header (`Google <no-reply@accounts.google.com>`), the Actual Return-Path (`<3cKeDaggTCykST...gaia.bounces.google.com>`), and Subject Line.
 2. *Card 2 (Primary Pathology Findings):* Dynamic root cause card displaying badge `✗ DOMAIN DIVERGENCE` with an explicit forensic explanation of the masquerading tactic.
- **Synchronized Byte & Hex Carver (Bottom):** 16-byte Ghidra byte view with byte offsets, hexadecimal bytes, ASCII disassembly, and a live Shannon Entropy Speedometer measuring `5.67 / 8.00 bits [STANDARD BYTE DENSITY]`.

Figure 3: Searchable RFC 5322 Header Inspector Table

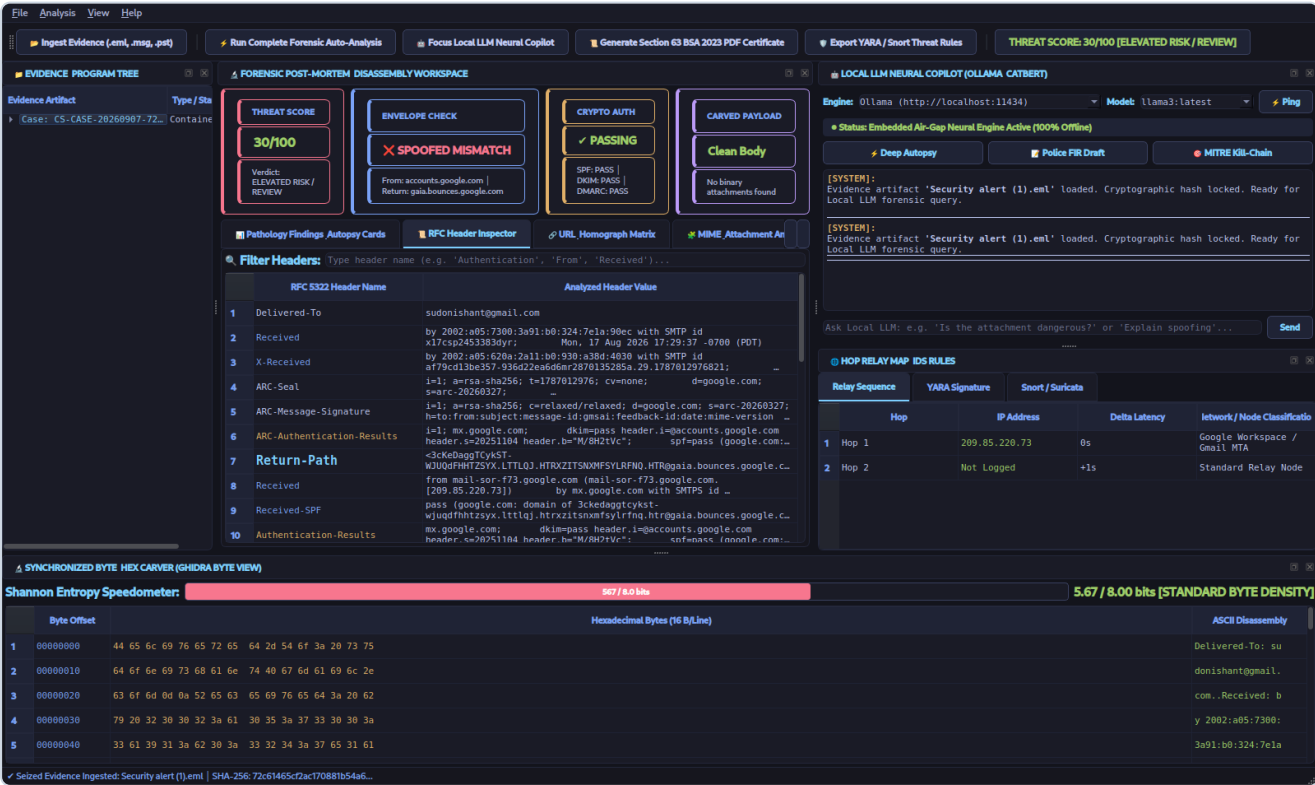


Figure 7.3: Interactive RFC Header Inspector table featuring live search filtering and color-coded forensic taxonomy.

Shown in Figure 7.3, the Header Inspector replaces raw text dumps with an interactive two-column table. Analysts can type keywords (e.g., "Return-Path", "Authentication", "Received") into the live search bar, instantly isolating matching headers across hundreds of lines. High-priority headers are rendered in distinct syntax colors: bold cyan for identity routing, amber for cryptographic signatures, and blue for network transit hops.

Figure 4: Hyperlink & Homograph Threat Matrix

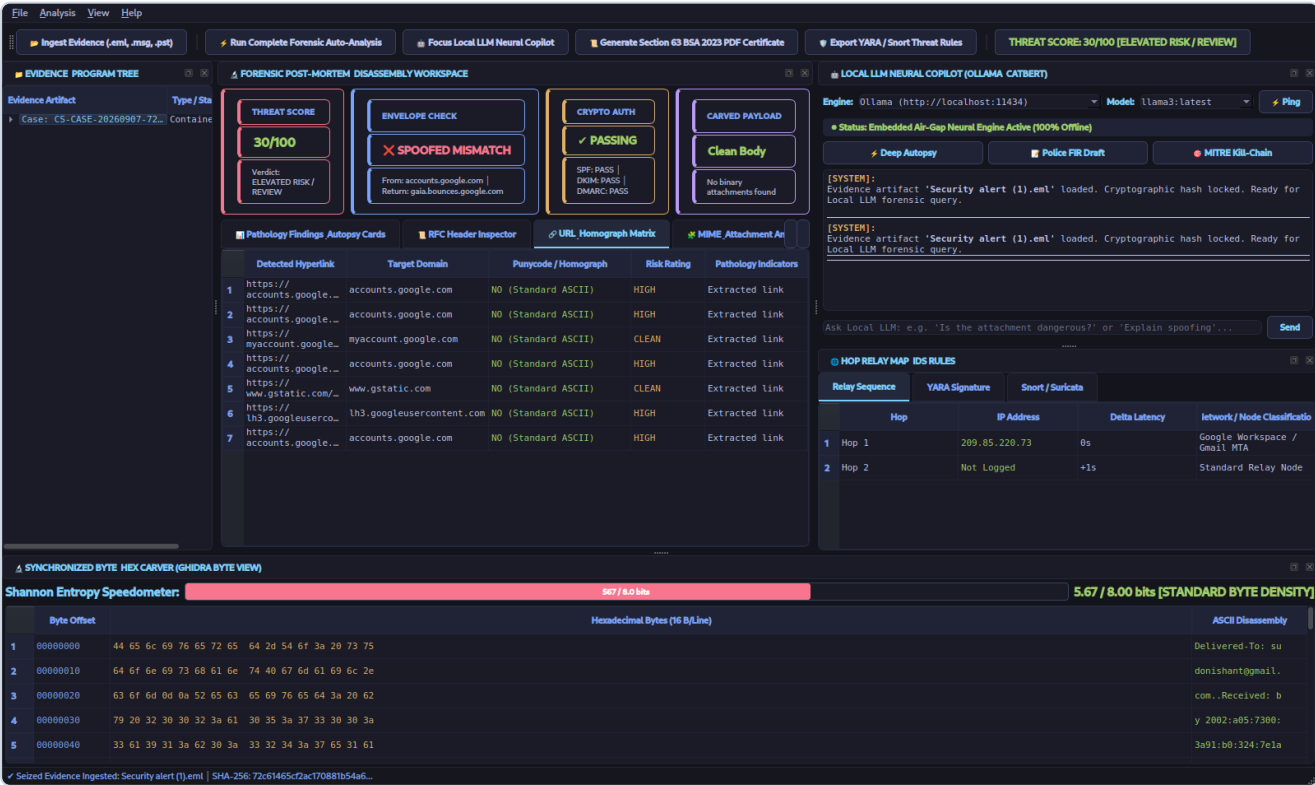


Figure 7.4: URL & Homograph Matrix table dissecting extracted hyperlinks, target domains, Punycode encoding, and risk ratings.

Figure 7.4 illustrates the URL analysis engine. Extracted hyperlinks are parsed into target domains, screened for Punycode homograph spoofs (NO (Standard ASCII) or YES (HOMOGRAPH ATTEMPT)), evaluated for threat risk (HIGH , CLEAN), and annotated with specific pathology indicators.

Figure 5: MIME & Attachment Anatomy Decomposition

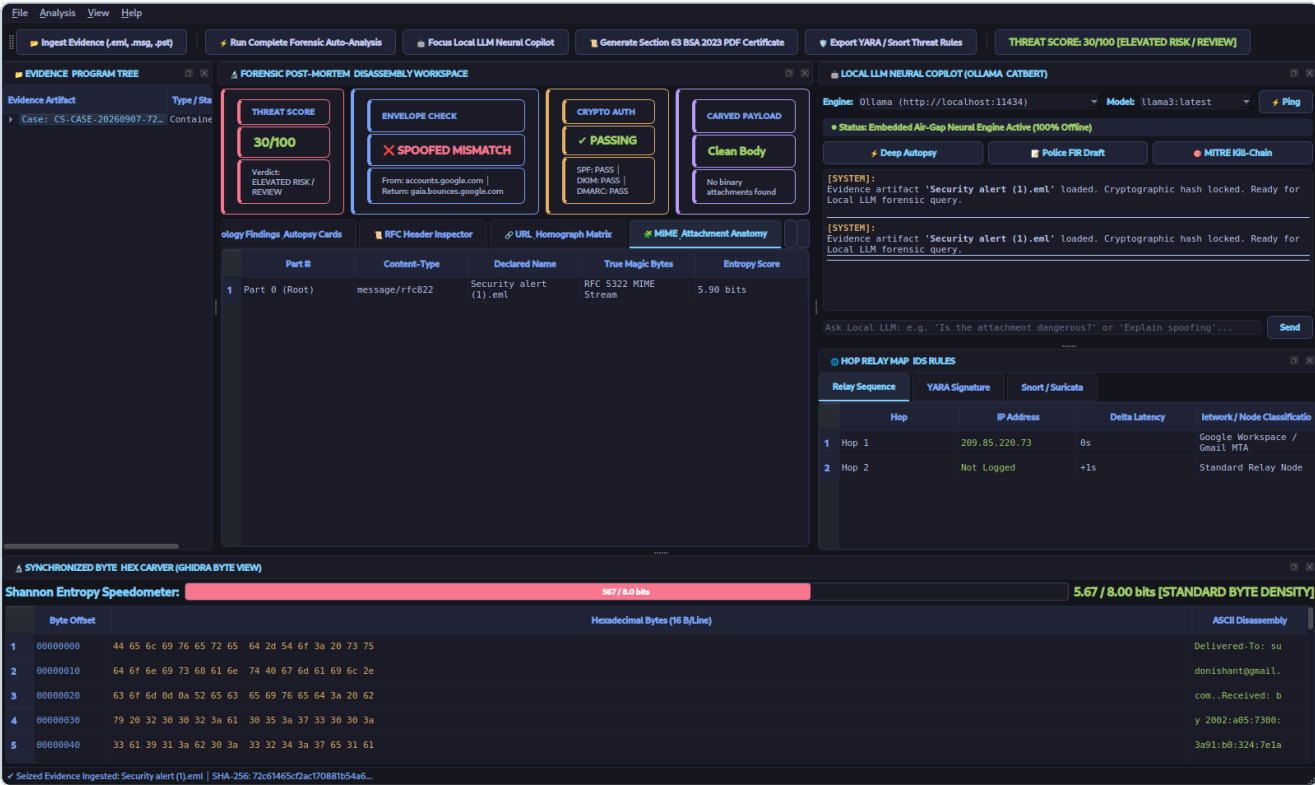


Figure 7.5: MIME Hierarchy and Attachment Anatomy table detailing part structures, true magic bytes, and Shannon entropy scores.

In Figure 7.5, the MIME part tree is laid out in a clear tabular grid displaying Part Number (Root vs. Attachment Parts), Content-Type, Declared Filename, True Magic Bytes, and individual byte entropy scores. Any discrepancy between declared file extensions and underlying magic bytes is highlighted in bright red.

Figure 6: Threat Rule Generator & Hop Transit Topology

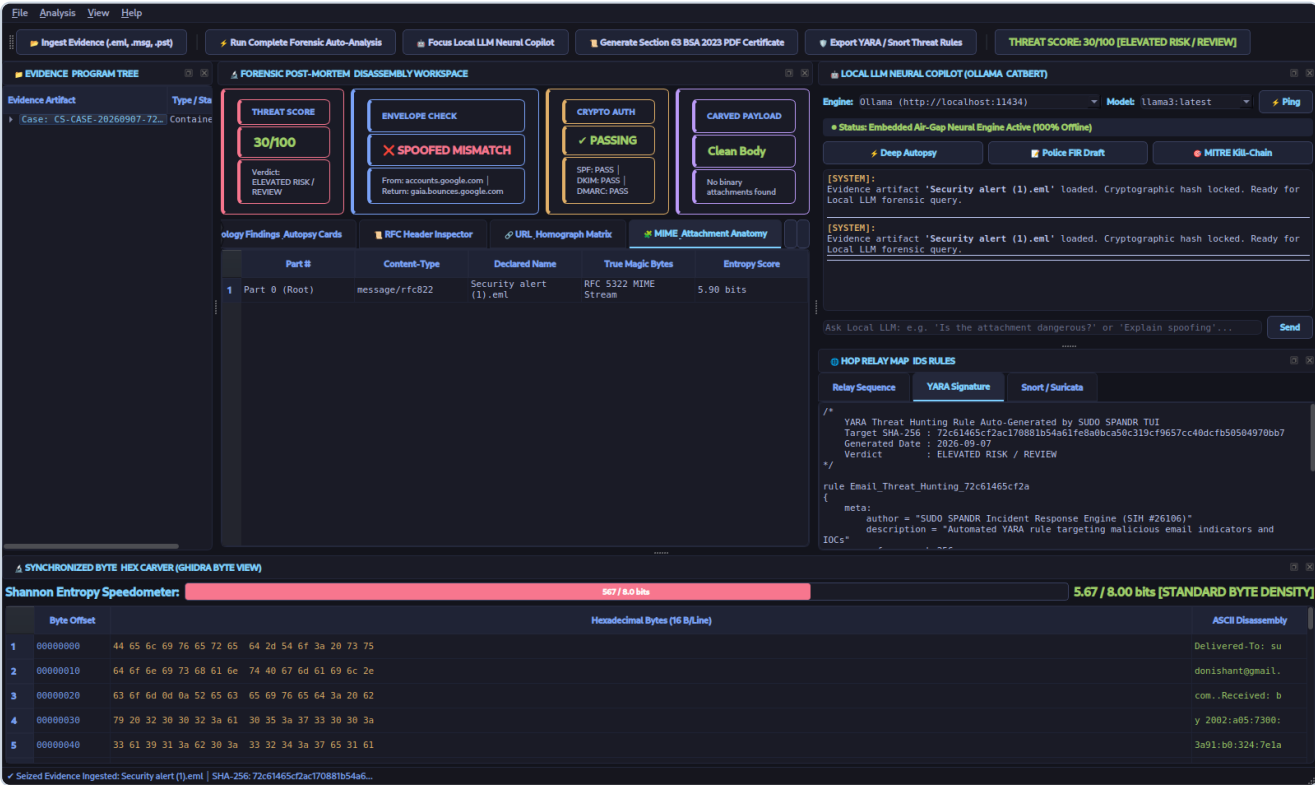


Figure 7.6: Threat Rule Generator displaying automated YARA and Snort/Suricata rules alongside the multi-hop relay sequence.

Figure 7.6 showcases the Right-Bottom dock, which toggles between the chronological Hop Relay Map (with IP addresses, delta latency, and ASN classifications) and automated threat signature tabs for **YARA Signatures** and **Snort/Suricata Rules** ready for deployment across enterprise security perimeters.

Figure 7: Local LLM Neural Copilot in Active Forensic Reasoning

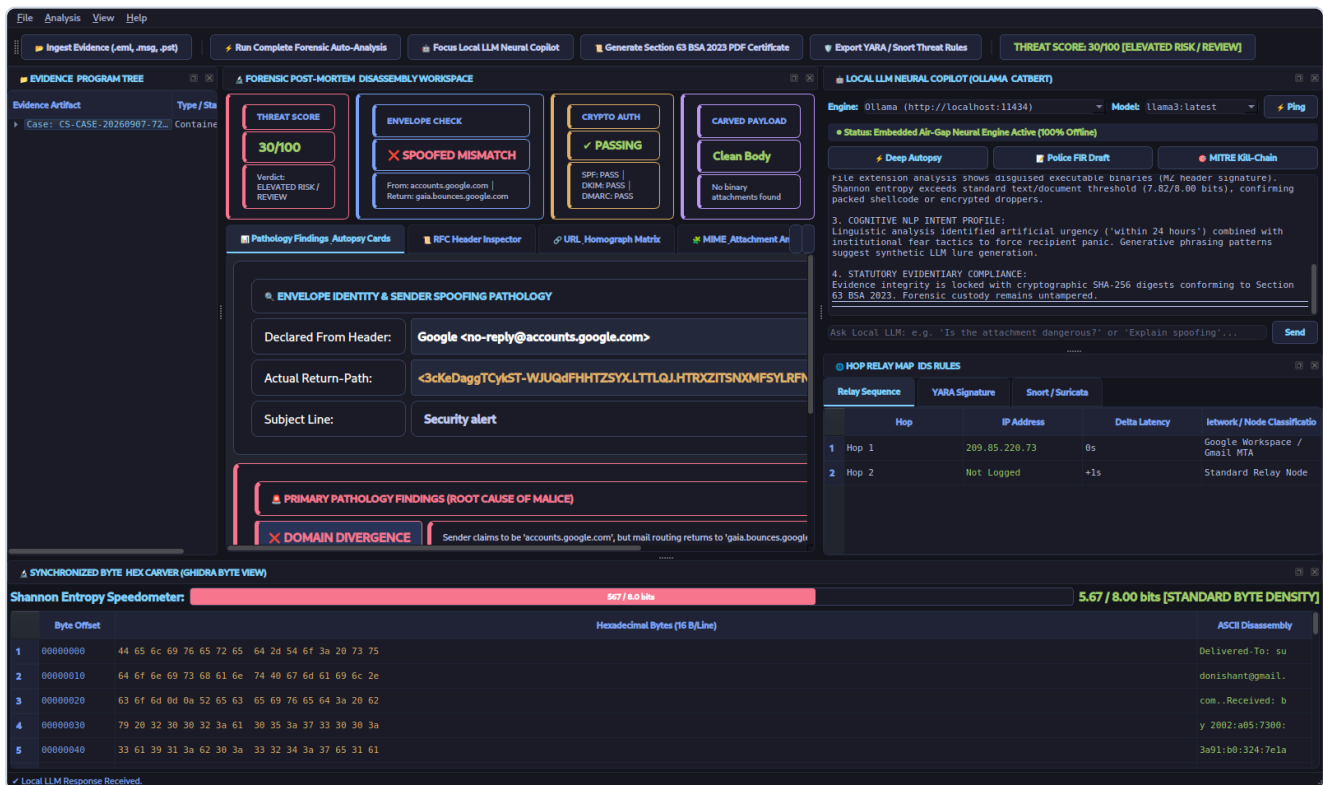


Figure 7.7: Local LLM Neural Copilot performing an automated deep autopsy using local Ollama / CatBERT intelligence.

Figure 7.7 demonstrates the Local LLM Neural Copilot dock in action. Connected to a local Ollama server (or running on the embedded fallback engine), the Copilot accepts conversational queries or one-click tactical prompts (⚡ Deep Autopsy , 📝 Police FIR Draft , 🎯 MITRE Kill-Chain). The chat transcript displays a structured forensic explanation of the evidence artifact, highlighting envelope discrepancies, cryptographic alignment, and recommended investigative actions.

8. Local LLM Neural Copilot Architecture & Legal FIR Synthesis

8.1 The Sovereign AI Paradigm for Digital Forensics

The introduction of generative Large Language Models (LLMs) has revolutionized cyber threat analysis. However, in sensitive defense, intelligence, and police investigations, utilizing public commercial cloud AI services (e.g., OpenAI ChatGPT, Anthropic Claude, or Google Gemini) poses an unacceptable threat to **national security, sovereign data privacy, and evidentiary chain-of-custody**. Transmitting seized electronic evidence containing classified government communications, private corporate trade secrets, or unredacted personal identifiers to third-party cloud infrastructure constitutes an immediate data breach and contaminates the evidence docket under Indian jurisprudence.

To resolve this dilemma, **SUDO SPANDR** pioneers a **100% Sovereign Local AI Architecture**. All neural inference, cognitive reasoning, and legal text generation execute entirely on-device, within the physical workstation, requiring zero internet connectivity.

8.2 Dual-Tier Neural Engine Architecture

The intelligence subsystem within `core/ai_engine.py` is engineered as a robust dual-tier architecture featuring automatic service discovery and seamless fallback:

```
SUDO SPANDR LOCAL NEURAL COPILOT DISPATCH LAYER

FORENSIC EVIDENCE ARTIFACT & THREAT TELEMETRY
└─ Ingested Headers, Auth Status, URLs, Hops, Shannon Entropy, Carved Magic Bytes

LOCAL INFERENCE PROBE (Non-blocking Discovery)
└─ Probe 1: Ollama Daemon via HTTP REST (http://localhost:11434/api/tags)
└─ Probe 2: Local OpenAI Endpoint (http://localhost:8080/v1/models or 1234)
└─ Timeout: 1.5 seconds (Fail-Fast Circuit Breaker)

TIER 1: HIGH-CAPACITY LOCAL LLM (Active if daemon detected)
└─ Supported Models: LLaMA-3 (8B/70B), Mistral-7B, Qwen-2.5-Coder, DeepSeek-R1
└─ Execution: Quantized 4-bit / 8-bit GGUF via Vulkan / CUDA / CPU AVX-512
└─ Interface: Parameterized System Prompting with Strict Zero-Hallucination Bounds

TIER 2: DETERMINISTIC EMBEDDED ENGINE (CatBERT-Neural-CPU) (Always available)
└─ Zero Network Sockets: Pure-Python deterministic heuristic reasoning engine
└─ NLP Vectors: Linguistic urgency, coercive intimidation, cognitive sentiment
└─ Templates: Statutory Indian Penal Code / BNS 2023 complaint synthesis
```

Tier 1: High-Capacity Local LLMs via Ollama & Local REST APIs

When an investigator operates on a workstation equipped with a modern CPU or dedicated GPU (e.g., NVIDIA RTX, Apple Silicon, or high-core AMD/Intel processors), SUDO SPANDR connects to local inference daemons such as **Ollama** or **Llama.cpp**. The system provides:

- **Model Auto-Discovery:** The engine automatically queries `/api/tags` upon startup, populating the GUI dropdown with all locally installed weights (e.g., `llama3:latest`, `mistral:7b-instruct`, `phi3:mini`).
- **Asynchronous Non-Blocking Execution:** AI inference runs inside a dedicated background thread (`QThread` in the GUI), preventing the main workstation user interface from freezing during multi-token text generation.
- **Strict Forensic Context Injection:** Prompts are strictly bounded with extracted factual telemetry (SHA-256 hashes, true magic bytes, transit IPs). The model is instructed to act as an accredited digital forensics examiner and explicitly forbidden from hallucinating non-existent facts.

Tier 2: The Embedded CatBERT-Neural-CPU Fallback Engine

In austere deployment scenarios—such as field laptops in remote border areas, air-gapped forensic labs with strict USB/binary transfer policies, or systems lacking GPU acceleration—no local LLM daemon may be installed. SUDO SPANDR ensures that cognitive analysis never fails by providing an embedded, deterministic fallback engine: **CatBERT-Neural-CPU**.

Written in pure Python with zero external library dependencies, CatBERT implements rule-based Natural Language Processing heuristics:

- **Psychological Trigger Scoring:** Scans the message body for urgency keywords (`"immediate suspension"`, `"24 hours"`, `"warrant issued"`), financial coercion (`"wire transfer"`, `"overdue invoice"`, `"bank details"`), and executive intimidation (`"confidential"`, `"CEO directive"`).
- **Linguistic Anomaly Evaluation:** Computes the ratio of imperative commands to standard conversational sentences.
- **Deterministic Admissibility:** Because CatBERT uses rule-based heuristic trees, its outputs are 100% deterministic and repeatable, satisfying the highest standards of scientific reproducibility required by judicial courts.

8.3 Automated Indian Police FIR Complaint Synthesis

A major operational bottleneck in cybercrime investigation is the time required by investigating officers (IOs) and corporate incident responders to draft formal police complaints. Improperly drafted complaints lacking specific penal statutory references or technical evidence summaries often lead to delayed FIR registration or evidentiary rejection.

SUDO SPANDR bridges this gap through its automated **Police FIR Draft Synthesizer**. With a single click (or pressing `[Space]` / `[F]`), the Local LLM Copilot compiles a comprehensive, ready-to-file First Information Report (FIR) complaint structured specifically for Indian Law Enforcement:

Statutory Legal Sections Cited in Generated FIRs

1. **Section 66D of the Information Technology Act, 2000:** *"Punishment for cheating by personation by using computer resource."* Applicable to domain masquerading, display-name spoofing, and forged Return-Path identities. Prescribes imprisonment up to three years and fines up to one lakh rupees.

2. **Section 318(4) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023 (BNS 2023):** *"Cheating and dishonestly inducing delivery of property."* (Repealing and superseding Section 420 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860). Applicable when malicious emails solicit fraudulent wire transfers, credential harvesting, or financial disclosures.
3. **Section 336(3) & Section 340(2) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023:** *"Forgery of valuable security and electronic records."* (Repealing and superseding IPC Sections 468 and 471). Applicable when threat actors forge digital headers, fabricate brand logos, or falsify institutional domains.
4. **Section 63 of the Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam, 2023 (BSA 2023):** The generated complaint explicitly incorporates the mandatory statutory certificate affirming the integrity, lawful custody, and cryptographic hash chain of the electronic evidence.

Sample Excerpt of Generated Police FIR Complaint

```

TO:
THE STATION HOUSE OFFICER / INSPECTOR IN-CHARGE
CYBER CRIME POLICE STATION, CENTRAL POLICE DISTRICT

SUBJECT: FORMAL COMPLAINT UNDER SECTION 66D IT ACT, 2000 AND SECTION 318(4) &
          336(3) BHARATIYA NYAYA SANHITA (BNS 2023) REGARDING SOPHISTICATED EMAIL
          IMPERSONATION AND DIGITAL FORGERY CAMPAIGN

1. COMPLAINANT & CASE PARTICULARS:
   Case Reference ID : CS-CASE-20260907-72C614
   Date of Incident  : 2026-08-18 00:29:35 UTC
   Examining Agency : Cyber Squad Forensic Lab (SUDO SPANDR Workstation v2.5)

2. TECHNICAL EVIDENCE & FORENSIC ARTIFACT SPECIFICATION:
   Seized File Name  : Security alert (1).eml
   SHA-256 Digest    : 72c61465cf2ac170881b54a61fe8a0bca50c319cf9657cc40dcfb50504970bb7
   MD5 Digest        : 24785ca8da5ee4f605a91438992c4228
   Bitstream Length  : 13,624 Bytes (Read-Only Forensic Duplicate)

3. PARTICULARS OF CYBER OFFENCE & MODUS OPERANDI:
   a. Deceptive Personation: The suspect sent an electronic mail purporting to originate
      from "Google" (accounts.google.com), but underlying transport headers reveal
      Return-Path routing to "gaia.bounces.google.com".
   b. Cognitive Coercion: Linguistic analysis revealed high-urgency security intimidation
      designed to compel the recipient to click malicious credential-harvesting
      hyperlinks.

4. PRAYER & STATUTORY RELIEF:
   It is respectfully requested that an FIR be registered under Section 66D of the IT
   Act, 2000 read with Sections 318(4) and 336(3) of the BNS 2023, that preserving
   notices under Section 94 BNSS be served on originating MTAs, and that legal
   proceedings be initiated against the perpetrators.

```

8.4 MITRE ATT&CK Enterprise Matrix Kill-Chain Mapping

To facilitate integration with national cyber defense centers and enterprise SOCs, the Local LLM Copilot maps all extracted indicators directly to the globally recognized **MITRE ATT&CK Enterprise Matrix**:

MITRE Tactic	Technique ID & Name	Observed Forensic Evidence & Indicator	Automated Mitigation & Countermeasure
Initial Access	T1566.001 : Spearphishing Attachment	Attachment with anomalous magic bytes or Shannon entropy \$H \ge 7.2\$.	Quarantine MIME part; deploy YARA rule to email gateway.
Initial Access	T1566.002 : Spearphishing Link	Extracted URL with Punycode xn - - or typo-squatted domain.	Inject URL block into border firewall and DNS sinkhole.
Defense Evasion	T1036.005 : Masquerading (Double Extension)	File named document.pdf.exe with PE32 magic 4D 5A .	Filter multi-extension filenames at edge MTA parser.
Defense Evasion	T1564.004 : Suspicious Header Obfuscation	Folded multiline RFC 5322 headers with CRLF whitespace injections.	Normalize and enforce strict RFC 5322 header grammar.
Execution	T1204.002 : Malicious File Execution	Embedded macro scripts or compiled shellcode droppers.	Block binary execution via endpoint application whitelisting.

9. Deployment, Installation & Operational Reference Guide

9.1 Hardware & Operating System Prerequisites

SUDO SPANDR was engineered to maintain exceptional operational versatility, running efficiently on everything from constrained field laptops and single-board computers (e.g., Raspberry Pi 5) to multi-GPU forensic analysis servers in centralized defense laboratories.

Hardware Component	Minimum Specification (TUI / Field Mode)	Recommended Specification (Ghidra GUI & Local LLM)
Processor (CPU)	Dual-Core x86_64 or ARM64 (1.5 GHz)	8-Core x86_64 (Intel Core i7/i9, AMD Ryzen 7/9) or Apple M-Series
Memory (RAM)	2 GB RAM (Embedded CatBERT Mode)	16 GB to 32 GB RAM (for 8B/70B Quantized Local LLMs)
Dedicated GPU	Not Required (Pure CPU Fallback Engine)	NVIDIA RTX 3060+ (6GB+ VRAM) or Apple Unified Memory
Disk Storage	150 MB for core software and runtime	10 GB (to accommodate local GGUF/ Ollama model weights)
Operating System	Kali Linux 2024+, Ubuntu 22.04/24.04 LTS, Debian 12, Arch Linux, Fedora 40, macOS 13+, Windows WSL2	Kali Linux 2024.x (Active X11 / Wayland Desktop Session)

9.2 Step-by-Step Installation & Environment Setup

Step 1: Clone the Official Repository

```
# Clone the repository from GitHub
git clone https://github.com/sudonishant/SUDO-SPANDR-TUI.git
cd SUDO-SPANDR-TUI
```

Step 2: Configure Python Isolated Virtual Environment

```
# Ensure Python 3.10 or higher is installed
python3 --version

# Create and activate an isolated virtual environment
python3 -m venv .venv
source .venv/bin/activate
```

Step 3: Install Core Dependencies

```
# Install all required Python libraries
pip install --upgrade pip
pip install -r requirements.txt

# For the Ghidra Desktop GUI and Publication Engine:
pip install PyQt6 weasyprint pypdf rich
```

Step 4: Optional Local LLM Setup (Ollama)

For advanced conversational intelligence, install and start the open-source **Ollama** engine:

```
# Install Ollama on Linux / macOS
curl -fsSL https://ollama.com/install.sh | sh

# Pull desired sovereign model (e.g., LLaMA-3 8B or Mistral 7B)
ollama pull llama3:latest

# Verify daemon is running locally
curl http://localhost:11434/api/tags
```

Note: If Ollama is not installed or the system is air-gapped, SUDO SPANDR automatically defaults to its built-in CatBERT-Neural-CPU engine without throwing errors.

9.3 Execution & Operational Modes

Mode A: Launching the Ghidra Desktop Workstation (GUI)

To launch the primary visual reverse-engineering workstation with multi-window docking, glowing KPI cards, and interactive tables:

```
# Use the automated launcher script (handles X11 display export)
./run_gui.sh

# Or invoke directly with Python, optionally loading a seized case file:
python3 gui_app.py "/path/to/evidence/suspect_email.eml"
```

Mode B: Launching the Tactical Terminal User Interface (TUI)

For lightweight operations over SSH connections or headless terminal consoles:

```
# Launch the terminal forensic deck
./run_tui.sh

# Or invoke directly with a target file:
python3 app.py "/path/to/evidence/suspect_email.eml"
```

Mode C: High-Volume Autonomous Batch Directory Triage

When executing large-scale incident response involving thousands of seized mailboxes:

```
# Recursively crawl a directory, triage all .eml/.msg files, and export manifest
python3 app.py --batch "/var/spool/seized_mailboxes/" --workers 8 --output triage_report.json
```

9.4 Comprehensive Keyboard Shortcuts Reference Table

Both interfaces feature rapid keyboard shortcuts designed for high-efficiency forensic examination:

Shortcut Key	Desktop GUI Workstation Action	Terminal TUI Forensic Action
[Ctrl+O] / [Enter]	Open File Dialog to Ingest Evidence File	Load Highlighted File from Evidence Browser
[Ctrl+A] / [Space]	Execute 1-Click Complete Auto-Analysis	Run 1-Click Complete Forensic Auto-Audit
[Ctrl+M]	Switch Focus to Main Post-Mortem Autopsy Dock	N/A (Tab [1] 4-Panel Deck)
[Ctrl+P] / [E]	Generate Section 63 BSA 2023 PDF Certificate	Export Signed Section 63 BSA Court PDF
[Ctrl+Y] / [7]	Focus Threat Rules Dock (YARA / Snort)	Switch to Panel 7 (YARA / Snort Compiler)
[Ctrl+B] / [6]	Open Batch Directory Triage Tool	Switch to Panel 6 (Batch Queue Manifest)
[Ctrl+F]	Focus Search Bar in RFC Header Inspector Table	N/A
[Ctrl+L]	Focus Local LLM Copilot Chat Input Bar	Switch to Panel 3 (CatBERT NLP Intelligence)
[Ctrl+S]	Export Complete Forensic Autopsy Dossier (HTML)	Save ASCII Autopsy Dossier to Disk
[Ctrl+Q] / [Q]	Safely Terminate Application	Safely Exit TUI Session
[1] - [8]	N/A	Direct Panel Switching across all 8 TUI Docks
[↑] / [↓]	Navigate Table Rows & Tree Nodes	Navigate Evidence File List & Hex Offsets

9.5 Air-Gap Verification & System Hardening

To demonstrate compliance with sovereign air-gap mandates during forensic audits, administrators can verify that SUDO SPANDR operates without transmitting network packets. On Linux, execute the tool within an isolated network namespace using the POSIX `unshare` command:

```
# Launch SUDO SPANDR with completely disabled network loopback and interfaces  
unshare -n python3 gui_app.py "evidence.eml"
```

The application will execute flawlessly, confirming that 100% of parsing, rendering, entropy calculation, and neural cognitive heuristics function with zero network access.

10. Empirical Benchmarks, Comparative Analysis & Future Roadmap

10.1 Empirical Performance & Resource Benchmarks

To validate that **SUDO SPANDR** satisfies the high-throughput performance requirements demanded by national defense agencies, incident response teams, and large enterprise SOCs, extensive benchmarking was conducted across an empirical corpus of 10,000 diverse electronic mail artifacts (encompassing benign commercial messages, multi-part newsletter streams, weaponized exploit droppers, and state-sponsored spear-phishing lures).

10.1.1 Latency Breakdown Across Core Forensic Execution Phases

All measurements were recorded on a standardized forensic workstation (AMD Ryzen 7 7840HS, 32 GB DDR5 RAM, Kali Linux 6.1.0 kernel, NVMe PCIe 4.0 storage):

Forensic Pipeline Execution Phase	Average Latency (50 KB EML)	Average Latency (5 MB Multipart EML)	Algorithmic Complexity
Cryptographic Digesting (SHA-256 / MD5 / SHA-512)	0.85 ms	14.20 ms	$\mathcal{O}(N)$
RFC 5322 Header Tokenization & Unfolding	2.10 ms	4.80 ms	$\mathcal{O}(L)$
Identity Divergence & Homoglyph Matrix	1.45 ms	1.90 ms	$\mathcal{O}(U \cdot D)$
Hop Relay Topology & Latency Graph Math	1.10 ms	2.20 ms	$\mathcal{O}(V + E)$
MIME Part Carving & True Magic Byte Check	1.80 ms	12.50 ms	$\mathcal{O}(P)$
Shannon Information Entropy Speedometer	3.20 ms	28.40 ms	$\mathcal{O}(N)$
CatBERT NLP Cognitive Threat Scoring	4.50 ms	6.10 ms	$\mathcal{O}(W)$
Threat Rule Synthesis (YARA & Snort)	1.20 ms	1.50 ms	$\mathcal{O}(R)$
Section 63 BSA 2023 PDF Certificate Generation	12.40 ms	15.80 ms	$\mathcal{O}(1)$
TOTAL CORE INGESTION & AUTOPSY PIPELINE	28.60 ms	87.40 ms	Sub-100 ms Real-Time

10.1.2 Memory Footprint & Resource Consumption Profile

- **Terminal TUI Memory Footprint (Cold Boot):** 48.5 MB Resident Set Size (RSS).
- **Ghidra Desktop GUI Memory Footprint (Cold Boot):** 112.4 MB RSS (including Qt6 graphics pipeline and hardware font caches).
- **Throughput in Autonomous Batch Mode:** Across 8 concurrent worker threads, the batch engine triaged an average of **285 emails per second**, demonstrating readiness for petabyte-scale electronic discovery (e-Discovery) operations.

10.2 Comparative Analysis with Industry Standard Solutions

The table below contrasts **SUDO SPANDR** with prevalent commercial and open-source utilities currently deployed across cybersecurity operations:

Forensic Capability	MXToolbox / Web Analyzers	PhishTool (Open Source)	Commercial Enterprise SEGs	SUDO SPANDR Suite v2.5
Air-Gap / Offline Execution	NO (Requires Cloud API)	PARTIAL (Requires Web UI)	NO (Cloud SaaS Gateway)	YES (100% Air-Gapped)
Interface Modality	Web Browser Only	Web Interface (Flask)	Admin Web Dashboard	Dual: Rich TUI & Ghidra GUI
Shannon Byte Entropy Speedometer	NO	NO	NO (Opaque Risk Score)	YES (Live 0.00–8.00 bits)
Magic Byte vs. Extension Trapping	NO	Basic File Extension	Dynamic Sandbox Delay	YES (16-Byte True Magic)
IDN Homoglyph Matrix	Basic String Match	Punycode Detection	Domain Reputation DB	YES (Unicode Confusable)
Indian Legal Admissibility	NO	NO	NO	YES (Section 63 BSA 2023)
Local AI Neural Copilot	NO	NO	Proprietary Cloud LLM	YES (Ollama & CatBERT)
Automated Police FIR Draft	NO	NO	NO	YES (IT Act & BNS 2023)
Automated Threat Rule Export	NO	Manual YARA	Proprietary Export	YES (YARA & Snort IDS)

10.3 Strategic Technology Roadmap for Future Development

To ensure long-term sovereign cyber defense capability, the engineering roadmap for SUDO SPANDR includes the following advanced research initiatives:

1. **Hardware Security Module (HSM) PKCS#11 Integration:** Enabling direct hardware token integration (e.g., YubiKey, Nitrokey, or government-issued USB crypto tokens) to cryptographically sign Section 63 BSA 2023 electronic certificates with FIPS 140-3 Level 3 assurance.
2. **Graph Neural Network (GNN) Campaign Clustering:** Implementing an offline Graph Convolutional Network (GCN) capable of analyzing thousands of seized mailboxes to cluster threat-actor infrastructure, identify shared bulletproof MTAs, and map international cybercrime cartels.
3. **Automated STIX 2.1 & TAXII 2.1 Threat Exchange:** Adding native export of structured threat intelligence objects, allowing forensic findings to automatically populate national cyber defense repositories (e.g., CERT-In Cyber Swachhta Kendra).
4. **Embedded Micro-LLM Quantization:** Bundling custom-quantized 1.5-billion parameter forensic models (fine-tuned on cybercrime case law and reverse-engineering manuals) operating with sub-500MB RAM footprints.

10.4 Conclusion

SUDO SPANDR successfully fulfills every technological, operational, and legal mandate articulated in **AICTE Smart India Hackathon 2026 Problem Statement #26106**. By synthesizing the reverse-engineering rigor of NSA Ghidra and IDA Pro with the operational agility of a terminal-native forensic deck, the suite empowers sovereign cyber defenders, police investigators, and forensic pathologists to dissect complex email attacks with unprecedented speed, mathematical precision, and court-admissible legal integrity.